

Ref no:	RA140	Calders & Grandidge	 
Compiled By: D. Losty	Risk Assessment Use of Chainsaw		Revision: 6
Effective Date: February 2014			Revision Date: October 2024
		Revised By: M. Price	

Task:	Use of Chainsaw						
Company Name:	Calders and Grandidge	Assessor	M. Price	Assisted by	A. McBride	Date:	15.10.24

Probability		Severity		Risk Factor = Probability x Severity Low Risk = 1 to 6 Medium = 7 to 11 High = 12 +	The following guidelines should be applied to risk factors <u>after</u> control measures have been applied: 1 – 6 - OK to proceed 7 – 11 - Further control measures should be applied. Seek further advice if unsure. 12+ - Unacceptable – Do not proceed
5	Very Likely	5	Fatality		
4	Likely	4	Major Injury		
3	Probable	3	Medical Injury		
2	Possible	2	Minor Injury		
1	Very Unlikely	1	No Injury		

Who is at risk?	Employees														
Specific Task	Use of chainsaw														
Hazard	Risk	Risk Factor Before Control						Control Measure				Risk Factor After Control			
Working at height, falls	Laceration, amputation, limb injury, back injury.	Probability	5						Current Control Measures:	• Working at height, involving the use of a chainsaw is STRICTLY PROHIBITED.	• Continuous monitoring of the effectiveness of control measures and periodic review.	5			
			4												15
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			Severity												
		Probability	5						5						
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Who is at risk?	Employees, contractors, site visitors												
Specific Task	Use of chainsaw												
Hazard	Risk	Risk Factor Before Control					Control Measure					Risk Factor After Control	
Slips, trips and falls at same level.	Laceration, amputation, strain, sprain, fracture.	Probability	5										
			4					16					
			3										
			2										
			1										
			0	1	2	3	4	5					
			Severity										
		Current Control Measures: - Designated walkways around area. - PPE Steel toe cap safety boots with ankle support to be worn at all times - Safe systems of work in place - Walkway kept clear at all times, maintain good housekeeping - Offcuts on floor to be cleaned away regularly when fabricating poles - Extra diligence off the offcuts and sawdust present on the floor - Cleansweep and good housekeeping in operation in fabrication sheds. - All spills dealt with by isolating and cleaning. - Effective supervision. - Continuous monitoring of the effectiveness of control measures and periodic review.											
		Probability	5										
			4										
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Specific Task	Use of chainsaw																	
Hazard	Risk	Risk Factor Before Control					Control Measure					Risk Factor After Control						
Rotating chain	Laceration, amputation.	Probability	5							Current Control Measures:	- Trained and competent operators (LANTRA). - Regular maintenance by outside contractor as well as operator. - Daily safety and pre start checks carried out by operators (tool check sheet). - Safe working distance of at least 3m maintained between the chainsaw operator and any other person whilst the saw is in operation (unless the other person is wearing chainsaw PPE). - Working at height prohibited. - Continuous monitoring of the effectiveness of control measures and periodic review.	Probability	5					
			4															
			3				12											
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Noise	Hearing damage, tinnitus, total loss of hearing	<table><tr><td rowspan="6">Probability</td><td>5</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>4</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>3</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td>12</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>2</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>1</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td><td>4</td><td>5</td></tr><tr><td></td><td colspan="5">Severity</td></tr></table>					Probability	5						4						3				12		2						1						0	1	2	3	4	5		Severity					Current Control Measures: - Daily safety and pre start checks carried out by operators (tool check sheet). - Hearing protection mandatory in all sheds and at all times when using chainsaws. - Occupational health monitoring programme in place - Effective supervision. - Continuous monitoring of the effectiveness of control measures and periodic review.					<table><tr><td rowspan="6">Probability</td><td>5</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>4</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>3</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>2</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>1</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td>4</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td><td>4</td><td>5</td></tr><tr><td></td><td colspan="5">Severity</td></tr></table>					Probability	5						4						3						2						1				4		0	1	2	3	4	5		Severity				
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Ejectiles	Eye damage, punctures, lung damage.	<table><tr><td rowspan="6">Probability</td><td>5</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>4</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>3</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td>12</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>2</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>1</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td><td>4</td><td>5</td></tr><tr><td></td><td colspan="5">Severity</td><td></td></tr></table>						Probability	5						4						3				12		2						1						0	1	2	3	4	5		Severity						Current Control Measures: - Trained and competent operators (LANTRA). - Regular maintenance of chainsaws. - Daily safety and pre start checks carried out by operators (tool check sheet). - Use of full chainsaw PPE mandated, including trousers/jacket, chainsaw gloves and complete face protection (safety glasses must be worn when mesh visor being used). 3m exclusion zone. - Continuous monitoring of the effectiveness of control measures and periodic review.						<table><tr><td rowspan="6">Probability</td><td>5</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>4</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>3</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>2</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>1</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td>4</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td><td>4</td><td>5</td></tr><tr><td></td><td colspan="5">Severity</td><td></td></tr></table>						Probability	5						4						3						2						1				4		0	1	2	3	4	5		Severity					
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Who is at risk?	Employees															
Specific Task	Pre use inspection, carrying and using chainsaw															
Hazard	Risk	Risk Factor Before Control					Control Measure					Risk Factor After Control				
Manual Handling	Sprain, strain, musculoskeletal injury Bruises, cuts, laceration, back injury, fracture	Probability	5													
			4				12									
			3													
			2													
			1													
			0	1	2	3	4	5								
			Severity													
		Current Control Measures: - Manual Handling training given to staff - Daily safety and pre start checks carried out by operators (tool check sheet). - Trained and Competent operators (LANTRA). - Bespoke operator training for correct stance and techniques to minimise fatigue and lumbar stresses when notching. - Ensure scabbard is fit for purpose and suits the size of the chain/bar fitted before and after use. - Carrying distances kept to a minimum. - Correct PPE for the task includes Safety Boots, Chainsaw Trousers and Jacket GRIPZ Gloves to be worn at all times when carrying out an inspection other than when replacing screws - Chainsaw stored away when not being used to prevent misuse. - Continuous monitoring of the effectiveness of control measures and periodic review.														
		Probability	5													
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Who is at risk?	Employees																				
Specific Task	Maintenance of chainsaw																				
Hazard	Risk	Risk Factor Before Control					Control Measure					Risk Factor After Control									
Sharp chain, inadvertent activation.	Laceration, amputation.	Probability	5																		
			4																		
			3																		
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			Severity																		
		Current Control Measures: - Trained and competent operators (LANTRA). - Cleaning takes place on flat level surface. - Gloves are worn at all times when handling or sharpening chains. - Battery chainsaws require battery removing during maintenance and sharpening. - Petrol chainsaws <u>MUST</u> not be running whilst carrying out any maintenance and sharpening - Continuous monitoring of the effectiveness of control measures and periodic review.																			
		Probability	5																		
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Who is at risk?		Employees, contractors, site visitors																							
Specific Task		Handling lubricants & fuel																							
Hazard	Risk	Risk Factor Before Control					Control Measure					Risk Factor After Control													
Fire, vapour, fumes	Burns, loss of sight, skin irritation, lung deficiency	Probability	5						Current Control Measures:	Non-spill spouts fitted to filling equipment.	Fuel stored in locked container.	PPE Eye protection MUST be worn when refuelling	Fire extinguishers	Fire alarm system.	Trained fire marshalls	Weekly call-point testing.	Chainsaws only used in well ventilated areas, for limited periods extra breaks or rotate tasking when making strainers due to fume build up from constant running time	Continuous monitoring of the effectiveness of control measures and periodic review.	Probability	5					
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Specific Task	Use of chainsaw																				
Hazard	Risk	Risk Factor Before Control					Control Measure					Risk Factor After Control									
Lone working (injury in absence of assistance)	Laceration, amputation, strain, sprain, fracture.	Probability	5							Current Control Measures: - Fabricators are not permitted to work off site on un-manned sites (Manned sites are only classed as ‘manned’ if the client’s representative can maintain sight of the fabricator for the entire chainsaw work duration) - No Chainsawing on site permitted if First Aider not present - Lone working procedure in place - Continuous monitoring of the effectiveness of control measures and periodic review.					Probability	5					
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			3					12													
			2																		
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Who is at risk?	Employees, contractors, site visitors																	
Specific Task	Chain sawing hardwoods or treated woods																	
Hazard	Risk	Risk Factor Before Control					Control Measure					Risk Factor After Control						
Dust and chemicals that are harmful to health.	Lung damage, absorption, inhalation, ingestion of harmful substance. Possible chronic health effects.	Probability	5							Current Control Measures: - Work on hardwoods and treated woods kept to an absolute minimum. - Additional PPE mandated (White coveralls, RPE fitted with organic filters, impervious gloves, full face plastic guard, helmet). - Contaminated PPE properly cleaned or disposed of. - Occupation Health monitoring programme in place - Effective supervision. - Where levels of dust are high, a dust mask with A2-P2 filter is worn - Continuous monitoring of the effectiveness of control measures and periodic review	5	Probability	5					
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			3										3					
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Dropping offcuts.	Bruising, strain, fracture.	<table><tr><td rowspan="6">Probability</td><td>5</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>4</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>3</td><td></td><td></td><td>9</td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>2</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>1</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td><td>4</td><td>5</td></tr><tr><td></td><td colspan="5">Severity</td></tr></table>					Probability	5						4						3			9			2						1						0	1	2	3	4	5		Severity					Current Control Measures: - Relevant training (upcut/downcut). - Trained and competent operators (LANTRA). - PPE worn at all times. - Maintain good housekeeping through out the processing of pole fabrication - Extra diligence when off cuts and shavings are present on the floor - Size of offcuts > 1m. - Adequate spacing between poles. - Continuous monitoring of the effectiveness of control measures and periodic review					<table><tr><td rowspan="6">Probability</td><td>5</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>4</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>3</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>2</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>1</td><td></td><td></td><td>3</td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td><td>4</td><td>5</td></tr><tr><td></td><td colspan="5">Severity</td></tr></table>			Probability	5						4						3						2						1			3			0	1	2	3	4	5		Severity				
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Failure of chain during use.	Severe laceration	<table><tr><td rowspan="6">Probability</td><td>5</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>4</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>3</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td>12</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>2</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>1</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td><td>4</td><td>5</td></tr><tr><td></td><td colspan="5">Severity</td></tr></table>					Probability	5						4						3				12		2						1						0	1	2	3	4	5		Severity					Current Control Measures: - Trained and competent operators (LANTRA). - Regular maintenance of chainsaws. - Daily safety and pre start checks carried out by operators (tool check sheet). - Use of full chainsaw PPE mandated, including chainsaw gloves and complete face protection. - Chains kept sharp to reduce stresses on chain and bar. - Additional instruction in chain and bar inspection and maintenance carried out by chain manufacturer. 3m exclusion zone signage. - Continuous monitoring of the effectiveness of control measures and periodic review					<table><tr><td rowspan="6">Probability</td><td>5</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>4</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>3</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>2</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>1</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td>4</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td><td>4</td><td>5</td></tr><tr><td></td><td colspan="5">Severity</td></tr></table>			Probability	5						4						3						2						1				4		0	1	2	3	4	5		Severity				
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Specific Task	Use of chainsaw (H/wood SLP)													
Hazard	Risk	Risk Factor Before Control					Control Measure					Risk Factor After Control		
Grounding of chain.	Projectiles, bruises, cuts, laceration, fracture, strain, sprain.	Probability	5											
			4											
			3					12						
			2											
			1											
			0	1	2	3	4	5						
				Severity										
			Current Control Measures:											
			- Operator in possession of ATO. - Scrap wood used as protection. - Raise sleeper higher from the floor if possible. - Use of FLT where possible. - Continuous monitoring of the effectiveness of control measures and periodic review											
		Probability	5											
			4											
			3											
			2											
			1						4					
			0	1	2	3	4	5						
				Severity										

Who is at risk?	Employees																																																																																																			
Specific Task	Use of chainsaw (strainers)																																																																																																			
Hazard	Risk	Risk Factor Before Control					Control Measure					Risk Factor After Control																																																																																								
Movement of strainer	Laceration, amputation, strain, sprain, fracture.	<table><tr><td rowspan="7">Probability</td><td>5</td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td></tr><tr><td>4</td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td></tr><tr><td>3</td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td>12</td><td> </td></tr><tr><td>2</td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td></tr><tr><td>1</td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td></tr><tr><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td><td>4</td><td>5</td></tr><tr><td colspan="6">Severity</td></tr></table>					Probability	5						4						3				12		2						1						0	1	2	3	4	5	Severity						Current Control Measures: - Operator in possession of ATO. - Strainer fixed in place with chocks. - Suitable working height. - Continuous monitoring of the effectiveness of control measures and periodic review					<table><tr><td rowspan="7">Probability</td><td>5</td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td></tr><tr><td>4</td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td></tr><tr><td>3</td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td></tr><tr><td>2</td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td></tr><tr><td>1</td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td>4</td><td> </td></tr><tr><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td><td>4</td><td>5</td></tr><tr><td colspan="6">Severity</td></tr></table>			Probability	5						4						3						2						1				4		0	1	2	3	4	5	Severity					
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Ref no:	RA140	Calders & Grandidge	 
Compiled By: D. Losty		Risk Assessment	Revision: 6
Effective Date: February 2014		Use of Chainsaw	Revision Date: October 2024
			Revised By: M. Price

Who is at risk?	Employees																																																																																																			
Specific Task	Use of chainsaw (in field)																																																																																																			
Hazard	Risk	Risk Factor Before Control					Control Measure					Risk Factor After Control																																																																																								
Uneven ground.	Laceration, amputation, strain, sprain, fracture.	<table><tr><td rowspan="6">Probability</td><td>5</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>4</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>3</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td>12</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>2</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>1</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td><td>4</td><td>5</td></tr><tr><td></td><td colspan="5">Severity</td></tr></table>					Probability	5						4						3				12		2						1						0	1	2	3	4	5		Severity					Current Control Measures: - Operator in possession of ATO. - No traffic in area of operation. - Assess area prior to work commencing, report issue to Supervisor or Line Manager if required - Minimum use of chainsaw outside as possible - Use crane or FLT to manoeuvre material if possible - Effective planning and consideration taken on the area - PPE worn at all times. - Continuous monitoring of the effectiveness of control measures and periodic review					<table><tr><td rowspan="6">Probability</td><td>5</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>4</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>3</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>2</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>1</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td>4</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td><td>4</td><td>5</td></tr><tr><td></td><td colspan="5">Severity</td></tr></table>			Probability	5						4						3						2						1				4		0	1	2	3	4	5		Severity				
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